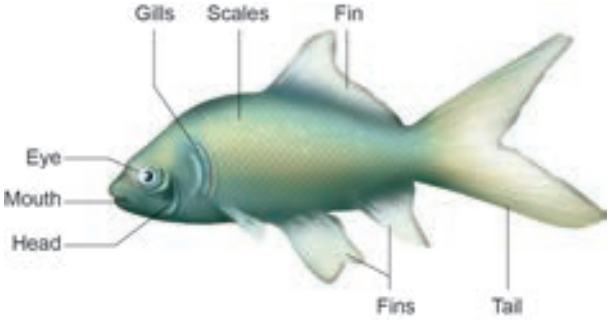
5.3 Adatptation in Animals

A Living thing can survive in a particular habitat if its body is adapted to the conditions of that habitat. Plants and animals develop special characteristics or features in their body in order to survive in their habitat (the surroundings). The presence of specific body features for certain habitats which enable a plant or an animal to live in a particular habitat is called adaptation.

The fish live either in freshwater or in marine water. Let us analyse the adaptations seen in fishes for their aquatic life.

Fish

1. The head, trunk and tail of a fish merge to form a streamlined shape. The streamlined body shape helps the fish to move through the water easily.
2. The fish has special organ called 'gills'. It is a respiratory organ which helps to absorb oxygen dissolved in water for breathing. It is adapted to breathe in water.
3. Most of the fishes have slippery scales all over the body which protect the body.
4. The fish has fins for fast swimming.



5. The fish has strong tail fin which acts as rudder to change direction and keep its body balance in water.

Frog

Amphibians lead a dual mode of life, living both in water and land. They are poikilothermic animals. Their body is divided into head and trunk with two pairs of limbs. During the larval stage, frog respire with the help of gills and the adult frog respire through skin, lungs and bucco-pharyngeal region.

Lizard

1. Lizards are scaly-skinned reptiles that are usually distinguished from snakes by the possession of legs, movable eyelids, and external ear openings.
2. They mostly inhabit warm regions. Most lizards are quadripedal (walk with four legs) and have a powerful limb.
3. Some lizards are able to run bipedally with two legs. In these lizards, the tail is held out backward and upward and acts as a counterweight.
4. Some lizards have the capacity to rotate the head around the head joint.
5. They breathe through lungs.